

WHISKERBOUND

Adventure, Co-op, Fantasy, Puzzle RPG

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CONCEPT

- Whiskerbound is a 2D top-down pixel-art cooperative adventure where Yoichi and Shuyi, along with their cat Neela, are drawn into a magical book and explore a bright, candy-colored world hiding a corrupt kingdom powered by stolen life force.
- As they climb through villages and cities stacked like a mountain, the couple switches between warrior and mage roles to solve puzzles, battle enemies, help villagers, and collect magical beads from Neela's collar that guide their journey upward.
- The world is ruled by a king obsessed with eternal youth, secretly draining the vitality of his citizens, while a mysterious companion travels with the couple, offering help but concealing his true identity.
- In the final act, the king attempts to fuse with Neela to achieve immortality, forcing players into a moral dilemma where their choices determine the fate of the cat, the kingdom, and the characters.
- Whiskerbound tells an emotional story about love, cooperation, sacrifice, and the courage to break destructive cycles.



GAME GENRE



Adventure



Co-op



Fantasy



Puzzle RPG

GAMEPLAY



Whiskerbound is a 2D top-down cooperative adventure where players control Yoichi and Shuyi, switching between their abilities to explore village-based levels with major sections, each containing three magical beads earned through puzzles, combat, and quests.



Combat focuses on attacking enemies and evading damage using well-timed dashes. Yoichi and Shuyi share the same attack mechanics but have different playstyles, making character switching important. Players must manage positioning, timing, HP, and SP carefully, especially during tough battles and boss fights.



Each bead level has an altar save point; after collecting the third bead, it merges the beads to increase HP and SP, unlock the next area, raise difficulty, reveal lore, and lead to a branching ending based on the final choice.

GAME MECHANICS

1 Character Switching & Cooperation

Players switch between Yoichi [Warrior] and Shuyi [Mage] using a dedicated button. Certain puzzles, enemies, and obstacles can only be solved using the correct character, making cooperation essential even in single-player control.

2 Combat Mechanics

Players use the attack button to defeat enemies and the dash button to evade incoming attacks. Yoichi focuses on physical strikes, while Shuyi wields elemental magic such as fire and water. Strategic character switching and dodging are essential to survive tougher encounters.

3 Puzzle Interaction

Environmental puzzles require activating switches, blocking hazards, timing movements, and combining both characters' abilities to progress. Many puzzles are designed so one character must act while the other benefits.

4 Health, Skill Points & Progression

Each character has HP and SP. Taking damage reduces HP, while using abilities consumes SP. Collecting and combining beads at altar save points increases maximum health, signaling long-term progression.

5 Beads & Level Progression

Each level contains three beads located in villages or major sections. Beads act as both rewards and guides, pointing players toward objectives and unlocking access to higher levels and the final area.

WHISKERBOUND STORYBOARD

Scene 0



The Whiskerbound main menu shows Neela sleeping beside a stack of books as leaves fall outside the window, creating a calm and cozy opening mood.

Scene 1

Yoichi and Shuyi argue intensely in a cutscene, their relationship clearly nearing a breakup. Only sound effects and music are heard, emphasizing emotional tension.



~ ~ ~ ~ ~

Scene 2.1



~ ~ ~ ~ ~

Neela sleeps peacefully on a table as rain pours outside. Thunder rumbles, creating a calm yet uneasy atmosphere.

Scene 2.2

A loud thud echoes through the room as a book falls from the shelf. Neela's ears twitch in response.



~ ~ ~ ~ ~

STORYBOARD

Scene 2.3



Neela slowly opens her eyes, now alert and curious about the sound.

Scene 3

The camera shifts to the bookshelf area, revealing a single book lying on the floor. It glows with magical light, pulsing softly.



Scene 4



Neela jumps down from the table and approaches the glowing book, pulled by its mysterious energy.

Scene 5

The scene cuts back to Yoichi and Shuyi still arguing. A sudden “meow” sound interrupts them, breaking their focus.



STORYBOARD

Scene 6



we get a new number for each n

A head-level view shows Yoichi, Shuyi, and the glowing book on the floor. The light expands until it fills the entire screen, signaling that the couple is absorbed into the book.

Scene 7

Yoichi and Shuyi wake up lying on the ground in a forest-like environment. The surroundings feel unfamiliar and magical.



Scene 8.1



What in the world is this place? What am I?

Shuyi questions their surroundings,
analyzing the strange environment calmly.

Scene 8.2

Yoichi reacts with concern and urgency,
focused on finding Neela.



Is this a dream? Where is Nidalo?

WHISKERBOUND STORYBOARD

Scene 9



The couple notices a small crater ahead and, driven by curiosity, slowly approaches it to see what might have caused it.

Scene 10

Tire tracks, pressed deep into the soil, are mixed with hoof marks and faint paw prints leading away from the crater, prompting them to follow the trail.



Scene 11

The trail ends at a massive fallen tree trunk blocking the path, preventing further progress.



Scene 12

Yoichi and Shuyi look to the left and notice a more secluded part of the forest.



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Scene 13



Entering the secluded forest, they find a small hut surrounded by training dummies, bushes, and forest decorations. The couple knocks on the hut's door.

Scene 14

Yoichi and Shuyi talk to a mysterious person in distress. They show understanding and compassion, slowly becoming acquainted.



Scene 15



As a sign of gratitude, the stranger gives Yoichi and Shuyi magical gemstones.



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Scene 16.1



After receiving the gemstones and heading back toward the blockage, the game UI fades in for the first time. [for Shuyi]

Scene 16.2

After receiving the gemstones and heading back toward the blockage, the game UI fades in for the first time. [for Yoichi]



Scene 16.3



"Candy Health" appears, indicating how much damage she can take.

Scene 16.4

"Skill Bar" appears, showing resource usage for special abilities.



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Scene 16.5



"Character-Switch" button appears, teaching players that switching between Yoichi and Shuyi is essential.

Scene 16.6

As a sign of gratitude, the stranger gives Yoichi and Shuyi magical gemstones.



Scene 17



The gemstones glow and transform—Shuyi gains a fire staff while Yoichi receives an axe.



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Scene 18



Working together, Shuyi burns the obstacle while Yoichi smashes it apart, proving that cooperation is the key to progress.

Scene 19

Yoichi and Shuyi arrive at the slum district, a dirty and crowded area that makes them uneasy. As they move through the streets, they meet a cautious local who hints at knowing something useful.



Scene 20



Yoichi and Shuyi ask the NPC about the tire tracks, hoof marks, and a missing cat or creature. The NPC agrees to share information, but only after they complete a favor first.

Scene 21

Yoichi and Shuyi discover a glowing altar hidden along their path, a strange bead resting at its center. Drawn by curiosity, they take the bead, unaware of its true purpose.



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Scene 22.1



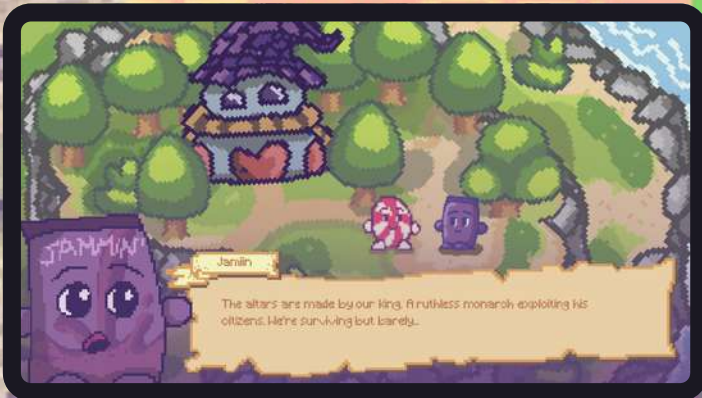
Yoichi and Shuyi finish the task requested by Story NPC 1, helping the slum in a small but meaningful way.

Scene 22.2

A small exclamation mark appears on the "Settings" icon, followed by a "Task Completed" message on the screen, confirming that the favor has been successfully finished.



Scene 23



Yoichi and Shuyi meet Story NPC 2, who explains the history and purpose of the altars but admits limited knowledge about the newly discovered beads. Grateful for the information, the NPC asks them to help with a task, which they agree to.

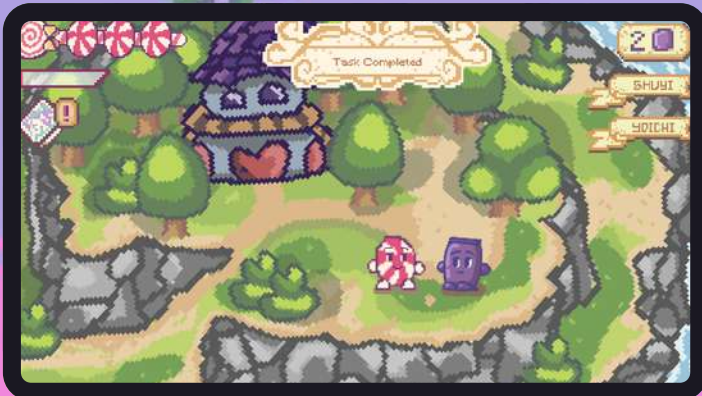
Scene 24

While completing the request, the couple discovers another altar with a bead. As they interact with it, the connection between the beads and their journey becomes clearer.



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Scene 25



Yoichi and Shuyi return to Story NPC 2 to report that the task is complete. With no more leads in the area, they set out and continue their journey deeper into the slums.

Scene 26

They meet a distressed worker near a cave entrance who explains they can no longer work because the king's troops have taken over the cave.



Scene 27



Moved by compassion, Yoichi and Shuyi enter the cave to confront the king's troops. Inside, the atmosphere turns hostile as enemy soldiers patrol the area, leading up to a confrontation with a powerful enemy, initiating the game's first boss fight.

Scene 28.1

A UI notification appears: "Boss Defeated!", confirming that Yoichi and Shuyi have successfully overcome the cave enemy.



WHISKERBOUND STORYBOARD

Scene 28.2



As the third bead is taken, it begins to glow and the nearby altar responds with a steady pulse of light, signaling that the beads can now be merged. A UI appears on screen: "Health Increased."

Scene 29

Story NPC 3 thanks the couple and points them toward the path leading to the second city, the central district.



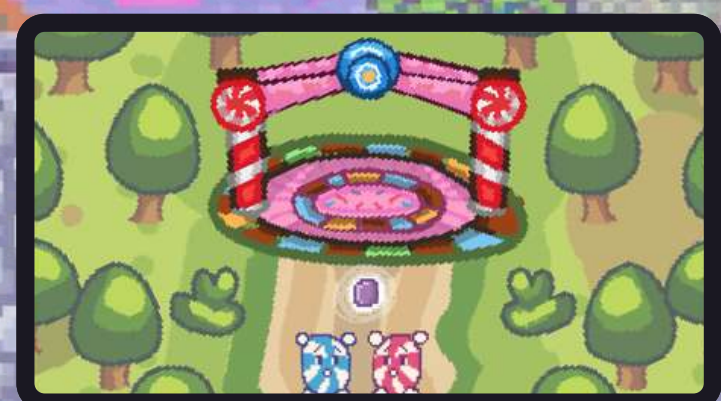
Scene 30.1



The bustling Central District shows the kingdom's heart with crowded streets, marketplaces, and tall buildings. Busy citizens fill the environment, emphasizing the city's scale and activity.

Scene 30.2

After completing the task, the couple finds a glowing altar. The altar pulses with light, signaling that beads can now be merged, following the same loop as previous cities.



WHISKERBOUND STORYBOARD

Scene 31.1



The Noble District features grand mansions, marble streets, and elegant gardens. Nobles and affluent citizens move about, creating an atmosphere of luxury and refinement.

Scene 31.2

After completing the task, the couple finds a glowing altar. The altar pulses with light, signaling that beads can now be merged, following the same loop as previous cities.



Scene 31.3



Because of their actions helping the people in previous districts, the King has become alarmed. Yoichi and Shuyi are now marked as fugitives, limiting their freedom of movement in the city.

Scene 32.1

Yoichi, Shuyi, and their companion reach the blocked gates, aware from rumors that the King plans to merge with Neela. Their companion reveals a secret passage to enter the castle



WHISKERBOUND STORYBOARD

Scene 32.2



A UI warning appears: "You cannot return after this point!". The trio navigates hidden paths, solving puzzles and battling enemies as they push deeper into the kingdom.

Scene 32.3

The throne room is filled with wizards and magical energy as Yoichi, Shuyi, and their companion prepare to face the unfolding ritual.



Scene 32.4



The King's aura flares as he speaks of creating a perfect world and enforcing absolute order. Just as the couple moved to stop the ritual, the King stepped forward with a surprising proposition.

Scene 32.5

A UI prompt emerges with three options representing the critical choice the player must make



WHISKERBOUND

STORYBOARD

Scene 33

"Your choice will determine the ending."

After making their choice, Yoichi, Shuyi, and their companion are plunged into unfolding events, with the outcome uncertain and everything at stake.

